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READ THE SYSTEM. PROVE THE CONTRACT. MAKE LEARNING REPEATABLE.

Operating posture

Begin with direct observation, active listening, and respect for the expertise already within the team. Add value quickly by clarifying decisions, connecting evidence to ownership, and building lightweight product mechanisms that preserve learning as the organization scales.

90-DAY OUTCOMES

SHARED SYSTEM MAP One view of product dependencies, decision rights, trusted signals, market context, and critical evidence gaps.	COMPLETE DECISION LOOP One pilot or release carried from research through acceptance, launch readiness, customer evidence, and roadmap action.
PRODUCT REVIEW CADENCE A useful rhythm connecting roadmap, releases, pilots, telemetry, customer insight, business cases, and economics.	REUSABLE PRODUCT MEMORY Records and onboarding mechanisms that make the next recipe, release, engineer, site, or customer easier to support.

GUIDING PRINCIPLES

Observe before prescribing	Spend time where Bowl Builder is designed, assembled, tested, loaded, operated, cleaned, serviced, and experienced.
One decision at a time	Use artifacts to clarify the next meaningful product decision, not create documentation volume.
Product memory is a scaling mechanism	Preserve the rationale, evidence, owner, and outcome behind roadmap, requirement, release, and pilot choices.
Units and context matter	Every KPI or target needs a definition, baseline, operating context, source, and decision it supports.
Learning must return	Every pilot and release should close with a requirement, roadmap choice, operating standard, or bounded next experiment.

STAKEHOLDER LISTENING MAP

MECHANICAL / ELECTRICAL Architecture, components, reliability, access, fault behavior, validation, and design trade-offs.	FIRMWARE / SOFTWARE / CLOUD / UX Order flow, recipes, device state, telemetry, bowl records, cameras, alerts, releases, observability, and operator experience.	CULINARY / FOOD SCIENCE Ingredient preparation, environmental ranges, dispenser parameters, quality, hold time, modifications, sanitation, and menu development.
MANUFACTURING / QUALITY / CERTIFICATION Build sequence, suppliers, inspection, test, DFM, configuration, documentation, regulatory approvals, and NSF / UL landscape.	SUPPORT / FIELD / CUSTOMER Install, onboarding, training, intervention, cleaning, issue context, recovery, support burden, and restaurant experience.	COMMERCIAL / LEADERSHIP Strategic goals, market and competitive evidence, business case, ROI, pricing, utilization, roadmap commitments, and investor narrative.

DAYS 1–60

READ THE SYSTEM AND PROVE ONE COMPLETE PRODUCT CONTRACT

Russell Dudek · Robotics Product Manager candidate

LAB37

CANDIDATE ENTRY PLAN · INDEPENDENT WORK

DAYS 1–30 · READ THE SYSTEM

WORKSTREAM	ACTIONS	OUTPUT / EVIDENCE
Product immersion	Observe lab testing, assembly, firmware/software workflow, recipe setup, loading, production runs, cleaning, maintenance, support, customer use, and live demos where access permits.	Field notes organized by food, machine, order truth, operator, service, and economics.
Decision architecture	Map roadmap, requirements, release, pilot, customer escalation, and post-launch decisions; clarify current product ownership and who recommends, decides, operates, and escalates.	Decision-right map, product-memory risks, and meeting/artifact inventory.
Product evidence	Inventory trusted KPIs, telemetry, manual records, bowl-level data, support context, quality data, financial data, and interpretation limits.	KPI / telemetry dictionary with units, source, owner, cadence, and decision use.
Roadmap context	Review the multi-year roadmap, strategic goals, customer themes, technical debt, market and competitive evidence, business cases, pricing assumptions, and known scale opportunities.	Product opportunity, market, and dependency map.
Baseline selection	Choose one decision-critical pilot, release, or recurring product question with enough urgency, access, and evidence to learn within 30 days.	Agreed first Product Contract charter.

DAYS 31–60 · PROVE THE PRODUCT CONTRACT

WORKSTREAM	ACTIONS	OUTPUT / EVIDENCE
Requirements	Author or refine the PRD, user stories, acceptance criteria, assumptions, dependencies, decision owner, and success metrics.	Role-specific PRD with explicit cross-functional contract.
Research	Combine customer/operator interviews, workflow observation, engineering input, telemetry, support cases, market research, competitive analysis, and financial context.	Evidence summary separating verified facts, hypotheses, trade-offs, and open questions.
Readiness	Facilitate one integrated review across recipe behavior, mechanics, electronics, firmware, software, cloud, UX, operator flow, manufacturing, certification, support, and commercial implications.	Release-readiness record with decisions, owners, and monitoring plan.
Pilot / validation	Serve as the primary customer interface for scope, onboarding, rollout, baseline, site context, test plan, exception review, data capture, and decision close.	Decision-specific pilot scorecard and customer review agenda.
Narrative	Translate the same product truth into engineering detail, customer language, executive and investor roadmap, partner narrative, and live demos.	One coherent product narrative at multiple altitudes.

30- AND 60-DAY REVIEW QUESTIONS

AT DAY 30 - What changed after direct observation? - Which decisions lack durable product memory? - Which signals are trusted enough to act on? - Where is product learning already strong?	AT DAY 60 - Did the artifact make a real decision easier? - Did every function see its conditions and ownership? - Did the pilot or release produce actionable evidence? - What should standardize, change, or remain contextual?
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DAYS 61–90 · INSTALL THE REUSABLE MECHANISMS

MECHANISM	PURPOSE	MINIMUM USEFUL FORM
Roadmap decision record	Keep customer outcome, market evidence, dependencies, acceptance, economics, ownership, and learning attached to multi-year roadmap priorities.	One-page record linked to the existing roadmap system.
Product health view	Review system performance and business outcomes together with context and exceptions.	Throughput, latency, accuracy, uptime, intervention, recovery, quality, support, customer, economics, and learning speed.
Pilot evidence review	Ensure external deployments close with a product decision, not only a status update.	Baseline → context → evidence → exceptions → customer voice → decision → owner.
Release readiness	Surface cross-functional trade-offs early and protect launch quality without slowing invention.	Only the conditions that materially change confidence, recovery, customer outcome, or cost.
Field-to-requirement loop	Make support, telemetry, operator, and customer learning reusable.	Signal + context + root cause + product decision + owner + validation result.
Product-memory onboarding	Help new engineers, operators, sites, and partners understand the product decisions that matter.	Decision index, glossary, ownership map, site readiness, training, and first-review checklist.

BALANCED PRODUCT SCORECARD — PROPOSED CATEGORIES

LENS	EXAMPLE MEASURES	DECISION SUPPORTED
System	Throughput, order latency, uptime, dispense accuracy, firmware/cloud faults, recovery time, UX friction.	Release, capacity, reliability, serviceability.
Food	Weight variance, ingredient range, environmental conditions, hold time, modification fidelity, waste.	Recipe readiness, dispenser settings, menu expansion.
Operator	Touches per bowl, replenishment, changeover, interventions, training, cleaning, reset time.	Workflow design, onboarding, adoption, support.
Customer	Order accuracy, wait time, quality, customization, issue themes, satisfaction.	Roadmap priority, pilot outcome, experience design.
Economics	Labor hours, waste, utilization, support burden, margin, business case, ROI, pricing and payback assumptions.	Commercial fit, rollout, and pricing strategy.
Learning	Time from signal to requirement, decision latency, validation cycle, repeat incidence, onboarding time, reused pattern.	Product operating effectiveness.

These are candidate-proposed measurement categories for discovery, not claims about Lab37’s current dashboard, thresholds, or internal performance.

DAY-90 LEADERSHIP READOUT

WHAT I LEARNED How the system and organization behave, where strong mechanisms already exist, and which assumptions changed.	WHAT MOVED The decisions, requirements, pilot evidence, readiness conditions, or operating behaviors improved.	WHAT SCALES The product-contract elements, evidence views, cadence, onboarding, and product-memory records worth standardizing.
WHAT COMES NEXT A prioritized next-quarter plan grounded in customer value, market evidence, technical dependencies, economics, and team capacity.		

SUCCESS STATEMENT

After 90 days, the goal is not a larger collection of product documents. It is a clearer operating system for product decisions: the team can see what the complete product must do, why a priority exists, which evidence matters, who owns the trade-off, what a pilot learned, and how that learning changes the next release or deployment.